

Mapping With Melanin™ — Production Audit Report

Date: August 7, 2026 | **Build:** Release 98.2 | **Auditor:** Manus Autonomous Audit

Executive Summary

The production environment is **largely stable** with the current bundle confirmed fresh and non-stale. Three critical issues require attention before the August 15 tour launch: the `/api/auth/user` endpoint returns `{"user":null}` on a **401 response** (the status code is correct but the body leaks a null user object — a partial fix), the `/api/city-launches` route returns **404** (the endpoint does not exist), and the `/api/cultural-sites` endpoint **times out** under the 20-second curl limit, indicating a severe performance problem with the full unfiltered query.

Section 1 — Build & Bundle Integrity

Field	Value
<code>railway_sha</code> (deploy trigger)	<code>d779df89de559a2a83b7bae98e1be2540e7495ce</code>
<code>built_from_sha</code> (compiled bundle)	<code>12516baf475c3c164760b209dcabcaf3e5c57049</code>
<code>stale_bundle</code>	false
<code>release</code>	Build-98.2
<code>built_at</code>	2026-08-07T17:31:14.084Z (today, ~6 hours ago)
<code>bundle_sha256</code> vs <code>bundle_sha256_self</code>	Match

Assessment: The deployed bundle is confirmed fresh. The `railway_sha` and `built_from_sha` differ (they always will — `railway_sha` is the git HEAD at deploy trigger time, `built_from_sha` is the commit the bundle was actually compiled from), but `stale_bundle: false` and matching SHA256 hashes confirm the running code matches the compiled artifact. **No stale bundle issue.**

Section 2 — Endpoint-by-Endpoint Audit

Check 1 — /api/version

Status	✓ PASS
Expected	SHA fields, stale_bundle status
Actual	HTTP 200, stale_bundle: false, both bundle SHA256 hashes match, built today at 17:31 UTC
Response Time	~2.8s
Tour Readiness	No impact — healthy

Check 2 — /api/readyz

Status	⚠ PARTIAL
Expected	HTTP 200, db: ok, pool healthy, fast response
Actual	HTTP 200, {"status":"ok","db":"ok","pool":{"total":2,"idle":1,"waiting":0}}
Response Time	2.2–9.9s (highly variable across 4 tests; first cold hit was 9.9s)
Tour Readiness	Moderate concern — pool is tiny (2 connections total) and cold-start latency is high

Notes: The pool size of 2 total connections with 1 idle is very small for a production environment heading into a national tour. Under concurrent load (multiple users hitting the site simultaneously during tour stops), this pool will exhaust quickly. The 9.9s first-hit response time suggests cold starts or connection establishment overhead.

Check 3 — /api/businesses

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Status	✅ PASS (auth gate working as designed)
Expected	Returns businesses list (or 401 if auth-gated)
Actual	HTTP 401 — {"error":"Authentication required. Please sign in to browse businesses."}
Response Time	~3.6s
Tour Readiness	Auth gate is live. Cannot verify diversity of business data without auth.

Notes: The businesses endpoint is correctly auth-gated. The error message uses "sign in" language which is appropriate. Cannot audit diversity of `culturalCommunity` fields without an authenticated session. The JS bundle confirms `black-owned` appears only as a filter tag ID (e.g., `{id:"black-owned",label:"Black-Owned"}`) — not as a generic default string injected into business records. The bundle contains **30 occurrences of "minority-owned"** and **0 occurrences of "Black-owned"** (capitalized, hyphenated) in the main app bundle.

Check 4 — `/api/cultural-sites`

Status	❌ FAIL — Performance
Expected	Returns cultural sites list; ~2,220 sites in database
Actual	HTTP 200 but times out at 20 seconds before completing response. Partial data received: ~233 sites in 247KB before cutoff. No <code>total</code> field found in partial response.
Response Time	>20s (timeout)
Tour Readiness	HIGH IMPACT — This endpoint is unusable in production. Any client hitting this will experience a timeout or hang.

Notes: The endpoint is returning data (confirmed: `{"sites":[...]}` structure, HBCU sites visible, correct schema), but the query is fetching all 2,220+ records without pagination and streaming them in a single response. This will cause timeouts for any user on a normal

connection. **Immediate fix required:** add `LIMIT / OFFSET` pagination or a `?limit=` parameter that is actually respected by the query.

Check 5 — `/preview`

Status	✅ PASS
Expected	Animated preview page loads with phone mockups
Actual	HTTP 200, 76.8KB standalone HTML page, full animation CSS present (<code>@keyframes</code> <code>slideInFromTop</code> , <code>fadeUp</code> , <code>slideInFromBottom</code>), 5 preview cards render correctly, no JS errors in browser console
Response Time	~3.0s
Tour Readiness	No impact — healthy and visually impressive

Notes: The preview page is a self-contained HTML file (not the SPA), loads instantly, and renders all 5 role-based preview cards with animations. This is tour-ready.

Check 6 — `/api/auth/user` (Unauthenticated)

Status	⚠️ PARTIAL — Status code correct, body incorrect
Expected	HTTP 401 with <code>{"error":"Unauthorized"}</code> or similar clean error
Actual	HTTP 401 ✅ but body is <code>{"user":null}</code> ⚠️
Response Time	~2.6s
Tour Readiness	Low impact for end users, but technically incorrect

Notes: The auth fix is **half-deployed**. The HTTP status code is correctly 401 (not 200), which means the auth gate is working. However, the response body still leaks `{"user":null}` instead of a proper error object like `{"error":"Unauthorized"}`. This is not a security vulnerability (the 401 status prevents access), but it is a spec violation. A client that only checks the body (not the status code) would incorrectly think a user is logged in with a null value. **Should be fixed** but is not tour-blocking.

Check 7 — `/api/city-launches`

Status	✗ FAIL — Route does not exist
Expected	List of 16 cities with <code>live_unclaimed</code> status
Actual	HTTP 404 — <code>{"error":"Not found"}</code>
Response Time	~4.3s
Tour Readiness	HIGH IMPACT — If the frontend city launch map depends on this endpoint, it will show nothing

Additional route probes:

Route	Status	Body
<code>/api/city-launches</code>	404	<code>{"error":"Not found"}</code>
<code>/api/cities</code>	500	<code>{"error":"Failed to load cities"}</code>
<code>/api/launches</code>	404	<code>{"error":"Not found"}</code>
<code>/api/city-launch</code> (singular)	404	<code>{"error":"Not found"}</code>
<code>/api/admin/city-launches</code>	403	<code>{"error":"Forbidden"}</code> (exists, auth-gated)

Notes: The admin endpoint exists (403 = auth required, not 404), which confirms the city-launches data exists in the system. However, the **public-facing route is missing entirely**. The `/api/cities` endpoint returns a 500 server error, indicating a database query failure. **This is a critical gap** — the tour launch depends on cities being visible to users.

Check 8 — Language Audit (Black-owned vs. minority-owned)

Status	✅ PASS (with one noted exception in preview)
Expected	No generic "Black-owned" defaults in public-facing endpoints or UI
Actual	Main JS bundle: 0 occurrences of "Black-owned" (capitalized), 30 occurrences of "minority-owned". Homepage SEO: "minority-owned" used throughout.
Tour Readiness	No impact — language audit is deployed in the main app

Exception noted in `/preview` page (static HTML):

The standalone `/preview` page contains two instances of "Black-owned" used as **specific business labels** in a mock travel card for Atlanta:

- "Landmark • Black-owned since 1947" (The Busy Bee Cafe — a real historically Black-owned Atlanta landmark)
- "Community Favorite • Black-owned" (Slutty Vegan ATL)

Assessment: These are contextually appropriate — they describe specific named businesses' cultural identity, not a generic default category label. This is consistent with the One-Way Mirror Rule (businesses self-identify; the app reflects that identity). This is **not a violation** of the language audit requirement.

Check 9 — `/api/waitlist`

Status	⚠️ PARTIAL — GET is 404, POST works
Expected	Waitlist endpoint functional
Actual	GET <code>/api/waitlist</code> → HTTP 404. POST <code>/api/waitlist</code> → HTTP 201 ✅ with full response
POST Response	<pre>{"success":true,"position":20,"referralCode":"MWM-TEST-1449","familyAdded":0,"id":"2db6dd96..."}</pre>

Response Time	POST: ~2.7s
Tour Readiness	Functional for its primary use case (joining the waitlist). GET probe is expected to 404 if not implemented.

Notes: The waitlist submission flow works correctly end-to-end: accepts email + city, returns position, referral code, and UUID. The GET 404 is expected behavior (listing all waitlist entries would be an admin function). **This is tour-ready.**

Check 10 — Homepage (/)

Status	✓ PASS
Expected	Homepage loads with correct content and no errors
Actual	HTTP 200, 3.7KB HTML shell (SPA), React app hydrates correctly in browser. Full content renders: hero, waitlist form, feature sections, testimonials, footer. No JS console errors.
Response Time	~2.2s
Tour Readiness	No impact — healthy

Homepage content confirmed:

- Title: "Mapping With Melanin™ — Find Minority-Owned Businesses & Community" ✓
- Waitlist form functional ✓
- Navigation links present ✓
- Social proof / testimonials present ✓
- App store CTAs present ✓

Bonus Check — Privacy Policy (/privacy-policy)

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Status	✅ PASS
Expected	Privacy policy page accessible with actual policy content
Actual	HTTP 200, full 12-section privacy policy renders in browser. Last updated June 21, 2026. Covers CCPA, data retention, cookies, children's privacy.
Response Time	~2.8s
Tour Readiness	No impact — healthy and legally complete

Section 3 — Specific Change Verification

Change Requested	Status	Evidence
Auth fix (401 for unauthenticated, not 200 with null)	⚠️ PARTIAL	HTTP status is correctly 401 ✅, but body is <code>{"user":null}</code> instead of <code>{"error":"Unauthorized"}</code> ⚠️
Language audit (minority-owned not Black-owned in generic contexts)	✅ DEPLOYED	Main bundle: 0× "Black-owned", 30× "minority-owned". Homepage SEO uses "minority-owned" throughout. Preview page uses "Black-owned" only for specific named businesses (contextually correct).
City launches (16 cities should be live_unclaimed)	❌ NOT DEPLOYED	<code>/api/city-launches</code> → 404. <code>/api/cities</code> → 500 server error. Admin endpoint exists (403) but public route is missing.
Cultural sites visible (2,220 should be in database)	⚠️ PARTIAL	Endpoint returns data (correct schema, HBCU sites confirmed) but times out before completing. ~233 sites received in partial response before 20s timeout. Database likely has the records but the query has no pagination.

Privacy policy URL accessible	 DEPLOYED	/privacy-policy → HTTP 200, full 12-section CCPA-compliant policy, last updated June 21, 2026.
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Section 4 — Tour Readiness Summary

Check	Status	Severity	Tour Impact
Bundle integrity / stale check	 PASS	—	None
Health check (/api/readyz)	 PARTIAL	Medium	Pool size (2) may exhaust under tour traffic
Businesses endpoint	 PASS	—	Auth-gated as expected
Cultural sites endpoint	 FAIL	Critical	Times out; unusable in production
Preview page	 PASS	—	None — tour-ready
Auth/user (unauthenticated)	 PARTIAL	Low	Status 401 correct; body leaks {"user":null}
City launches endpoint	 FAIL	Critical	Route missing; cities not visible to users
Language audit	 PASS	—	None
Waitlist endpoint	 PASS	—	None — tour-ready
Homepage	 PASS	—	None — tour-ready
Privacy policy	 PASS	—	None — legally compliant

Overall Verdict: CONDITIONAL GO — 2 Critical Blockers Before Aug 15

Critical (must fix before tour):

- /api/cultural-sites **timeout** — Add LIMIT / OFFSET pagination to the query. Default to

`limit=50` or `limit=100` . The endpoint cannot stream 2,220+ records in a single response.

2. `/api/city-launches` **missing** — The public route does not exist. The admin route (403) confirms the data is there. The public GET route needs to be registered in the Express router.

Should fix (not tour-blocking):

3. `/api/auth/user` **body** — Change response body from `{"user":null}` to `{"error":"Unauthorized"}` on 401.
4. `/api/cities` **500 error** — Server error on this route suggests a broken DB query. Investigate and fix.
5. **DB connection pool** — Consider increasing pool size from 2 to at least 5–10 before tour traffic begins.

Audit conducted via curl from sandbox environment. All endpoints tested against `https://www.mappingwithmelanin.com` . Timestamps in UTC. Build 98.2 deployed 2026-08-07T17:31:14Z.